FF-P-416e
December 5, 1963

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. FF-P-00416d (GSA-FSS)
August 22, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. FF-P-416b
May 24, 1955

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PINS, SAFETY

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Type and grade. Safety pins covered by this specification shall be of but one type and one grade.

1.2 Sizes. The safety pins shall be of the sizes shown in 3.4, as specified (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

QQ-B-613—Brass, Leaded and Non-Leaded; Flat Products (Plate, Bar, Sheet and Strip).
QQ-W-321—Wire, Brass.
PPP-B-566 — Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-591—Box, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-B-676 — Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-10547—Liners, Case, Waterproof.
MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

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(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The wire used in the fabrication of the safety pins shall be cold-drawn, spring tempered brass wire conforming to the requirements for composition 6 or 7 of QQ-W-321.

3.1.1 *Guard and cap.* The guard and cap shall be made of drawing temper sheet brass conforming to composition 1 or 2 of QQ-B-613.

3.2 Design. The safety pins shall conform in design and construction to conventional commercial safety pins.

3.2.1 *Spring.* The spring shall be formed by one and one-half turns of the wire.

3.2.2 *Guard and cap.* Safety pins shall be furnished with or without guard, as specified (see 6.1). The guard shall be clamped around approximately one-third to one-half of the circumference of the spring, securely enough to prevent its falling off, but not so secure as to restrict the function of the spring. The cap shall be constructed so as to permit easy closure and opening from either side of the cap.

3.2.3 *Point.* The free end of the pin shall gradually taper to a sharp point.

3.3 Finish. All surfaces of the safety pins shall be uniformly and heavily plated with nickel of a thickness used in standard commercial practice.

3.3.1 *Resistance to corrosion.* When tested for resistance to corrosion as specified in 4.4.2, the total surface of any pin showing corrosion shall not exceed 2 percent.

3.4 Dimensions. The safety pins shall conform to the sizes and measurements shown in table I.

3.5 Workmanship. The safety pins shall be free from any defects which affect the appearance or which may affect the serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier's responsibility. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 *Size of lot.* All pins of the same size, presented for delivery at one time, shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination and tests.

TABLE I.—*Dimensions*

Commercial size	Diameter of finished wire (tolerance— ± 0.001 inch)	Length (tolerance— ± 1/16 inch)	Thickness of sheet brass for cap (tolerance— ± 0.001 inch)	Minimum thickness of sheet brass for shield (guard)
Number	*Inch*	*Inches*	*Inch*	*Inch*
1 (Small)	0.0335	1-1/16	0.010	0.006
2 (Medium)	.0410	1-1/2	.012	.006
3 (Large)	.0500	2	.015	.006
6 (X Large)	.0700	3	.015	Unguarded

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4.2.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination and for tests.* Random sample boxes of pins shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level S-2. Lot acceptance or rejection shall be based upon an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 2.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one box, except that ten pins, taken at random from the box, shall be examined as in 4.3.1. If there are one or more defects in the sample of ten pins taken from the box, the whole box shall be considered defective and shall be rejected.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 *Visual and dimensional examination.* Samples taken as specified in 4.2.2 shall be visually examined to determine compliance with the design, finish, dimensional, and workmanship requirements of this specification. Any sample unit containing one or more visual defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective samples exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be subjected to the following tests. Any sample failing one or more tests shall be considered defective. If the number of defective samples exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1 *Magnetic properties.* The sample pins shall be brought in contact with a magnet to determine whether steel or iron has been employed in their manufacture instead of brass. Pins containing steel or iron will not be acceptable.

4.4.2 *Resistance to corrosion.* The safety pins taken for tests shall be boiled in distilled water in a glass beaker for 30 minutes and allowed to remain submerged for 24 hours. The surfaces of the pins shall then be examined for corrosion.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement Fed. Std. No. 102 should be referred to for the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Unless otherwise specified, pins in unit quantities of the same size, shall be packaged in boxes conforming to PPP-B-566, type and style optional, or PPP-B-676, type and style optional. The number of pins per box shall be as shown in table II. Each box shall be waterproofed in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Pins shall be packaged in boxes as specified in 5.1.1 except that waterproofing shall not be required.

5.1.3 *Level C.* The pins shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice.

5.1.4 *Intermediate packaging.* Twelve units of pins shall be intermediate packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, type and style optional. Sealing and closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The unit and intermediate containers, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in quantities in accordance with table II, in any of the following containers at the option of the contractor:

Specification	*Type or class*
PPP-B-591	Overseas type
PPP-B-601	Overseas type
PPP-B-621	Class 2
PPP-B-636	Class 2
PPP-B-640	Class 2, grade A

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The gross weight of wood boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds. The gross weight of fiberboard boxes shall be subject to the limitation of the box specification. Each shipping container shall be provided with a sealed case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Intermediate packages of pins shall be overpacked in quantities specified in table II in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 1. The container shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The pins shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military activities.* In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the unit, intermediate and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Size required (see 1.2).
(*c*) Guard, whether or not required (see 3.2.2).
(*d*) Inspection responsibility if other than as specified herein; and administrative provisions for inspection records, when applicable (see 4.1).
(*e*) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Transportation data. Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to the commodity covered herein are:

Rail:

Pins, wire, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Pins, wire, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

TABLE II.

Commercial size	Length (inches)	Pins per unit	Units per intermediate container	Intermediate cartons per shipping container
1	1-1/16 (small)	96	12	12
2	1-1/2 (medium)	72	12	12
3	2 (large)	48	12	12
6	3 (X large)	24	12	12

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6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.4 This specification covers only the types, sizes, etc., of the commodity as generally purchased by the Federal Government, and is not intended to include all of the types, etc., which are commercially available.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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